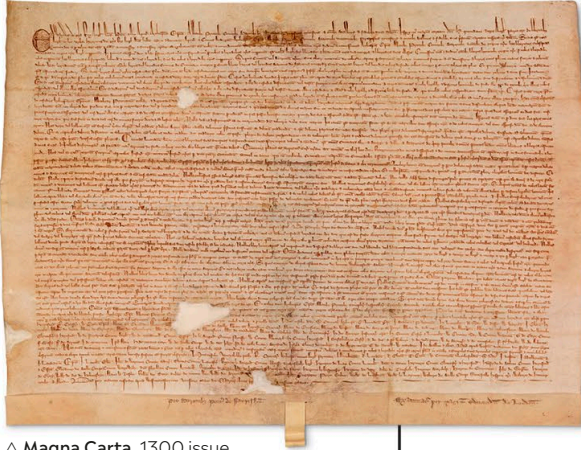


1215

MAGNA CARTA

A milestone in human rights, the Magna Carta was a triumph for powerful English barons in revolt against the ruling monarch, King John (r. 1199-1216). They forced him to sign the document agreeing not to arbitrarily imprison his subjects or impose taxes without their consent. It later became a fixed reference point in English law.



△ Magna Carta, 1300 issue

1218

DEATH OF KHMER RULER JAYAVARMAN VII

Considered the greatest ruler of the Cambodian Khmer Empire, which lasted from the 9th to the 15th century, Jayavarman (r. 1181-1218) successfully fought the neighbouring kingdom of Champa. He made Mahayana Buddhism the state religion, building the temple of Bayon at his capital, Angkor Thom.



◁ Jayavarman VII, bronze head

1234 The Mongols conquer northern China, destroying the Jin dynasty

1239

1212 Spanish Christians defeat the Almohad Muslims at Las Navas de Tolosa

1235 The Mali Empire is founded by Sundiata Keita in West Africa

1221

JOKYU WAR IN JAPAN

Under the Kamakura shogunate, from 1185, the emperors of Japan were reduced to figureheads, with real power exercised by samurai warrior clans. In 1221, retired emperor Go-Toba attempted to reassert imperial authority against the dominant Hojo clan, who ruled as regents for the Kamakura shogun.

With ruthless energy, the Hojo descended upon the imperial capital Kyoto in a devastating attack that swept away the emperor's supporters. Go-Toba was exiled to a remote island off western Japan.



△ Emperor Go-Toba forges a sword; print by Utagawa Kuniyoshi, c. 1840